



TLD MIS Management process description

February 2011

Management Information Systems (MIS) is a TLD Group controlled function which is operationally shared by a team of local IT employees in order to keep a better close contact with the users.

TLD Organization systems are under the responsibility of the TLD Group Chief Operating Officer. However, for each TLD process/systems, one key TLD operational employee, who is known "Module Operational Owner" or MOO is in charge of controlling and coordinating its development with the designated IT expert.

MIS is an important tool to develop and structure consistent TLD Organization systems within the TLD group. The reality is that, more and more, new processes requires MIS tools to be developed and that MIS tools structure the way people do process their work. To simplify, let's say that more or less:

Organization & processes = MIS tools

TLD org systems and MIS are TLD group controlled functions because it is critical for TLD to develop convergent processes and procedures that are the result of all users' ideas, knowledge and efforts of benchmarking. The good ideas of some TLD BU's need to be shared and promoted to others.

In term of responsibility breakdown, it is important to note the following key points:

- Major MIS priorities are continuously determined by the TLD Group COO that continuously stays in close contact with the IT director, the TLD Executives through in particular the feedback from the MIS meetings
- MIS team does not take decisions regarding TLD org systems but can contribute like anyone else from TLD
- The IT Group director brings his contribution to the TLD Org. systems evolution like any other TLD Executive but his executive level contribution is reinforced by his deeper knowledge of the TLD Org. and MIS systems

Every one at TLD is invited to bring his ideas regarding the evolution of the TLD Org. and MIS systems. There are ways, tools and meetings for doing so.

TLD employees need to understand that their ideas will always be considered and analyzed. Nevertheless, due to the fact that processes need to be consistent group wide, there are some cases in which the ideas won't be retained or implemented because it may not fit everyone's concerns or may simply not be considered as an appropriate idea.

The role of TLD Executives and Management team is essential to convey this message to all TLD MIS users. TLD Executives must understand enough all main processes and MIS tools of TLD so they can insure their proper implementation within their area of responsibility.

IT Daily Management : MIS projects and TTS:

There are two tools to manage developments & issues for the MIS team: TTS and MIS Projects.

TTS – Trouble Ticket System:

Anyone at TLD is entitled to open a TTS for an IT problem or IT development idea he could have.

Through the TTS system, the TTS ticket will be directed to the most relevant IT team expert whose purpose will be to manage the issue as diligently as possible. The IT team expert is typically the **MIS owner** of the related module.

There are basically 3 types of TTS:

- TTS#1 : a request that requires a simple a quick fix that the MIS Owner can do immediately without having to refer to anyone else,
- TTS#2 : a request that could generate a significant change in one of the process of the company. In that case, the TTS will be transmitted to the Module Operational Owner (MOO) so he can validate or refuse the proposal, can communicate with others in the groups...etc,
- TTS#3 : a request of a new process, a new MIS tool, a major change that could be elevated to the point it generates a new MIS project after validation by the IT Group director and/or Group COO.

Please note that IT employees never close any TTS by themselves but ask the initiator of the TTS to close the TTS whenever they have implemented a solution. It means that the initiator can challenge the proposed solution and will always be informed of the consequences of his original request. In extreme cases, it may happen that the initiator has to acknowledge the fact his TTS has not been retained.

MIS projects: The MIS projects are large IT projects that require a clear specification from the users, TLD Executive management approval, allocation of significant IT resources, to be discussed at group wide level by the “Module Operational Owner” (MOO) in order to get large input.

Each MIS project has an Importance Factor (controlled by the Group COO) and an estimated date of implementation as well as different statuses (see below)

Typically, one MIS Project will comprise many independent TTS to be implemented MIS projects are usually initiated as a result of Steering Committee or Executive Committee decisions, discussions in the monthly MIS meetings or as the raising of particularly interesting ideas raised by any TLD employee through the TTS system.

MIS projects are also usually opened for major upgrades of TLD modules. IT then open a MIS project phase#2 or #3..for developing new functions of a module.

The MIS projects have several statuses to help their control:

1. OPEN: a project has been **opened** (recorded) but no action has been taken yet
2. SPEC: the MOO is currently communicating with his counter parts and writing the **specification**
3. DISC: the specification is being **discovered** and **discussed** between the MOO, the IT Group Director, the group COO and the IT owner for corrections and final validation.
4. DEV: the specification has been agreed on and the application is currently being **developed** by the MIS owner

5. **PROTO**: the IT tool is being **prototyped** and the MOO has access to it for initial testing. This is the stage in which the MOO is supposed to develop the help page of the module and to start training the potential users
6. **BETA**: the IT tool is now activated in **BETA** version to the users and requires continuous follow up by the MOO and MIS owner for improvements and debugging
7. **ACCEPT**: the IT tool has been debugged, is fully operational and is accepted as is by the MOO and test users. It is now in deployment phase in all BU's.
8. **CLOSED**: The MIS project is no longer an IT subject and is then **closed**.

Role of the MOO (Module Operational Owner or MIS project Operational Owner)

Mission: The MOO is the main correspondent of the IT team for any MIS project or any module or any ERP area of expertise. The MOO insures the good communication between the Operational world and the IT world.

The list of MOO is continuously available online at Intranet/MIS/Module. In each module, a link with the name of the owner should also be available

In his mission, the MOO typically does the following:

- initiates module or MIS tool development or improvements,
- writes the specification of the requested development or improvements,
- communicates with all his counterparts and/or relevant persons to insure that the specification is agreeable to all and that all local needs are considered and decisions are taken,
- communicates and explains the specification to the IT team, listens to the IT proposal and accepts to be constructively challenged during this process,
- supplies continuous support to the IT team during development when things in the specification are unclear,
- tests the MIS tools and help the debugging,
- develops the help page of the module, the detailed IT process and communicates it to all relevant parties
- at the disposal of his TLD colleagues for doing training and providing further advices
- promotes the use of the MIS tool within the whole TLD
- answers questions coming from IT people whenever TTS are raised by TLD employees regarding the further development of the tool. In that sense, the MOO is the one validating the suggested improvements of the module.

To be chosen as a MOO, the TLD employee needs to have the following profile:

- be an recognized TLD expert in the related field of the MIS project and/or Module
- be able to take enough distance with his own operational issues and to listen and consider other's points of view
- have shown some ability to communicate efficiently, proactively and transversally within the group
- be able to communicate fluently in English
- be fully supported by his hierarchy to assume his MOO mission

The MIS project communication and input to define priorities is achieved and gathered through a few key regular meetings: TLD steering Committee, EXECOM, Regional MIS Meetings and Weekly IT meetings.

EXECOM: This is a meeting where main MIS directions should be presented, discussed and challenged. It is then becoming the role of the Executives to relay the information to their employees.

Monthly MIS meetings:

The purpose of the monthly MIS meeting in each regional area of TLD is to insure a good communication between the IT team and the operational executives and managers. The monthly MIS meeting is also the opportunity to express the vision of the TLD Org system and MIS tools development.

All Regional Executives and as many managers as possible should try to assist to these MIS meetings.

The monthly MIS meeting is conducted by the regional MIS manager, supported by the RCEO&CFO.

TLD Group executives, in particular IT Group Director and Group COO, are permanently invited to these MIS meeting and attend once in while.

List of important items related to the Monthly MIS meeting:

- A systematic review of all local MIS projects statuses and actions should be presented by the regional MIS manager to all attendees
- A rapid overview of the progress of major MIS projects handled in other region should also be presented
- The MIS meeting attendees should raise their ideas, their comments about priority levels and their concerns about the IT tools and new IT developments. **After each MIS meeting, the main inputs gathered in the meeting should be communicated rapidly and systematically by the RCEO/CFO and local IT manager to the Group COO and IT Group Director in case they have not attended the meeting.**
- The MIS meeting is organized around the online tool displayed on a large screen in order to share the same level of information to all attendees and allocate tasks transparently

Weekly IT meetings or conference calls:

On a weekly basis, the IT group director invites each regional IT team to meet together in the weekly MIS meeting.

The purpose of these meetings is to:

- Check the status of each TTS
- Discuss about the difficulties
- Rapidly inform the regional team about the progress of the developments done in other area
- Provide feedback to the IT director regarding the user satisfaction and frustration regarding IT tools, IT development, hardware and speed issues